Instances for this type of data collection include information on addiction, marriage proposal, economic status, witnesses in court, criminal proceedings etc. The shortcoming of this method is genuineness and accuracy of the information, as it completely depends on the third party.

2.2.3 Questionnaire Method

A questionnaire contains a sequence of questions relevant to the study arranged in a logical order. Preparing a questionnaire is a very interesting and a challenging job and requires good experience and skill.

The general guidelines for a good questionnaire:

- The wording must be clear and relevant to the study
- Ability of the respondents to answer the questions to be considered
- Avoid jargons
- Ask only the necessary questions so that the questionnaire may not be lengthy.
- Arrange the questions in a logical order.
- Questions which hurt the feelings of the respondents should be avoided.
- Calculations are to be avoided.
- It must be accompanied by the covering letter stating the purpose of the survey and guaranteeing the confidentiality of the information provided.

Editing the preliminary questionnaire

Once a preliminary draft of the questionnaire has been designed, the researcher is obligated to critically evaluate and edit, if needed. This phase may seem redundant, given all the careful thoughts that went into each question. But recall the crucial role played by the questionnaire.

Pre Test

Once the rough draft of the questionnaire is ready, pretest is to be conducted. This practice of pretest often reveals certain short comings in the questions, which can be modified in the final form of the questionnaire. Sometimes, the questionnaire is circulated among the competent investigators to make suggestions for its improvement. Once this has been done and suggestions are incorporated, the final form of the questionnaire is ready for the collection of data.

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